The Mountainside

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1994-95: A Year of Community Focus

The Coolfont Mountainside Association moves into the new fiscal year with a full plate of jobs to be completed.

At the annual meeting in September, the membership made it clear they considered the issue of the water and sewer upgrade to be the first item in the "job jar" for CMA, and they wanted the process to get that upgrade started.

The largest question in that issue is financing. At the annual meeting, the membership unanimously passed a resolution which calls for the board to *"move forward with all deliberate speed to explore all alternatives to resolving problems relating to the water and sewer system, and that top priority be given to the use of all available tools with the exception of a common land trade".*

There are several avenues CMA is currently taking to meet that resolution's demands:

We are gathering more information on the realistic engineering and financing options available to us in upgrading the new system, and we are working to resolve our status with the West Virginia Public Service Commission. To gain new insights into water and sewer solutions, Gale Connor and Dwain Place attended the Small Water Systems Conference in Pennsylvania during October. Gale reports that the conference was very worthwhile, not only because of the seminars on system business and engineering operations, but also because of the contacts and "industry knowledge" they were able to gather there. Gale and Dwain will give the Board a report on their findings.

RESOLVING THE 1986 AGREEMENT WITH CDC

Also on the list of things to do is the resolution of the status of the 1986 agreement with CDC. At the October board meeting, the new board was unanimous that the effort to conclude the outstanding differences be started immediately. President Arleigh Greenblat appointed a negotiating team: himself, Don Green, and Jackson Bain.

At the Board Meeting at Jonathan Ormes home in October, Arleigh also appointed new Standing Committee Chairs for 1994/1995. They are:

DACC: Linda Clark
Finance: Bob Dowling
Recreation: Diane Kaseman
Coolfont Foundation: Renee Jasper

And the Board Member Liasion to each of three of the committees were also named:

DACC: Harold Radday
Finance: Jonathan Ormes
Recreation: Jackson Bain

MARK YOUR CALENDAR:

Next Board Meeting:

Saturday, November 5th

1:30 p.m.

AT COOLFONT

in Treetops

MOUNTAINSIDE SECRETS

Looking for a beautiful late afternoon drive, some new knowledge about our regional landscape, ending in a terrific dinner at a great restaurant? We suggest a ride up to Hancock, MD, turn West on I-70, continue on to head west on I-68 toward Cumberland, MD.

On the way, (about ten minutes from Hanckock) stop off at the Sideling Hill Visitor's Center (the ramp to parking comes right off the Interstate on the right). The exhibit inside details the geology and natural resources of the area. Of special interest is the display of local animal life, including Bobcat and Black Bear. The main exhibit describes the fascinating geological story revealed in layers when the hill was dug out. The center, run by the Maryland Park Service, is done very well, and is worth seeing.

Rosemary Bigelow suggests continuing on to Cumberland for dinner at JB's Steak Cellar. If you're a fan of home-grown beef, aged and cooked to perfection, Roesemary says this is the place. The specialty is prime rib, served with traditional horseradish and baked potato. She says the salads are terrific, and the side order of fresh roasted garlic cloves is worth the trip by itself. Rosemary also mentions that the desserts are very good, and they taste homemade.

Rerservations are strongly recommended, as the restaurant seems always busy on weekends.

✂

JB's STEAK CELLAR
PHONE (301) 722-6155

President's Notes

by
Arleigh Greenblat

TO BE OR NOT TO BE...

A professionally run and well managed association that commands respect, *or* another of America's homeowner associations with a reputation of service quality ups and downs...*that is the question.*

In a large annual meeting turnout on September 3rd, the membership gave the leadership a clear signal - *get on with the business of the association by solving our few remaining problems with the Coolfont Development Corporation, then go to work on our infrastructure.* To back up their view, the assembly voted strong support for a negotiation-arbitration solution to the water-sewer upgrade challenge. My clear impression was that the membership would support appropriate expenditures for legal assistance and that loan or assessment money to supplement any reasonable settlement ultimate achieved with CDC would be agreed to.

Also heartening was the absence of any rancor or division in our house which could have resulted from the defeat of the land trade proposal of last spring. To me, the assembly showed little patience with having its time use rehashing the past. Of most concern was the future.

Four new board members were elected, each representing fresh points of view and hope for a Coolfont Mountainside Association that runs on the high road.

Following the annual meeting, the new board met and pressed for an early start in the conduct of this year's business. After officer selection, each board member agreed to contribute time in providing liaison work with standing and ad hoc committees. Realignment of the past year's officer work load was agreed upon so that no one person would have an extraordinary burden. You should know that when I called for members to ask if they would chair or otherwise serve on committees, we received a 92% positive response!

I hope by the next annual meeting, CMA will be operationally structured so that for many years to come, effective use of human resources and consistency in delivering services to the membership will take place. We are well on the road to achieving respect from our members, the business community and governmental agencies with whom we work.

On behalf of the Board, our thanks is extended once again for your continuing support.

Arleigh

NEW DACC CHAIR CALLS FOR MEMBER IDEAS ON GUIDELINES REVISIONS

Linda Clark, newly appointed DACC Chair, has named Dwain Place and Pat Schenk to that committee, with Elmer Broxson as senior advisor. She also set some goals for the committee, and asked for member input on possible revisions to the current DACC guidelines. The following column is from her "letter to the editor" of The Mountainside:

I want to share with you our goals for the year. The first goal is to improve the overall process of building at Coolfont. This process should be as efficient and smooth as possible, as we encourage the construction of new homes. We are here to help, and to ensure that all of the new construction fits into our rustic green environment, and follows the current guidelines. Our response to all applications will be completed in a logical and timely manner.

As the new year begins, we will be evaluating all of the Guidelines regarding building at Coolfont. I encourage participation in this process by the individual members. In other words, I would like to hear from YOU! Please send your suggestions, either by mail or fax. I'd like to hear both what you think has worked in the past, as well as what has not worked, and how the process might be improved. Please be as specific as possible. Thank you!

Linda Clark

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VIEWS AND VOICES

This space each month will feature the opinions and viewpoints of our members on a variety of subjects. We encourage you to submit clear, concise opinion/editorial segments for editing and subsequent use in this column.

This month's feature is from Charles Balkan (4-H) *A Peaceable Balkan*:

> On hearing Stan Bigelow's talk at the Labor Day annual meeting, I was struck by his sense of accomodation between those owners with a "business" perspective and those, for want of a better word, with a more "natural" one.
>
> The natural setting is precisely what attracted me to Coolfont. I assumed that everyone felt the same way.
>
> It is incomprehensible to me that someone could look upon a Coolfont home as simply an investment. I think other values are inculcated there that are far more important than profit. A place like Coolfont calls for spending money to "buy" quiet, peace of mind, communing with nature, safety, beauty and tranquillity. Those who tie those attributes to lines on a balance sheet may be better served investing elsewhere. If this sound elitist, it isn't. It is just common sense to recognize that at a certain point, we can push to extinction the very thing we sought in the first place.
>
> Thank you for taking the time to read this letter.
>
> Charles Balkan

DO YOU HAVE AN OPINION?
SEND YOUR IDEAS AND INSPIRATIONS TO:
Jackson Bain
The Mountainside
913 King Street
Alexandria, VA 22314
FAX: (703) 549-9601

MEMBER PROFILES:

Each month, we will also feature profiles of our members. Here is our first, about a neighbor and friend we all know and love:

ALICE MINNAMON

Volunteer Extraordinary

Alice and her husband, Dick, and their two daughters moved to Coolfont in 1980, where they joined Alice's brother, Stan Bigelow, who moved to Coolfont two years earlier. Dick and Alice built their dream home on lots F-2 and F-3, and Alice has been a full-time resident ever since. Dick was CMA's first Operations Manager; Alice took over after his death in 1987.

Alice is responsible for maintaining CMA facilities - the pool, the roads (including snow removal), water, and our barn.

Although Operations Manager is a paid position, Alice volunteers about half the time she gives to CMA. She spends many hours on the phone, talking to homeowners, helping them find workmen, arranging for special barn and pool usage, and especially absorbing their frustrations over water and snow removal. Did you know that arranging for snow removal for your driveways is strictly a volunteer effort on Alice's part? Through late nights and holidays, Alice is always cheerful and gracious. We all owe her a debt of gratitude for her efforts and her caring.

Did you know?

- Alice is a full time teacher in the Morgan County School System, teaching the elementary gifted program, which she developed for the county

- Alice and her two brothers were born in a remote part of the Belgian Congo (now Zaire), where their parents were working with Africans to provide medical and educational services, and putting the native language into writing.

- Alice has two granddaughters, both born in 1993.

- Alice was not allowed to dance as a youngster, but has taken up Square Dancing now! Boogie on, Alice!